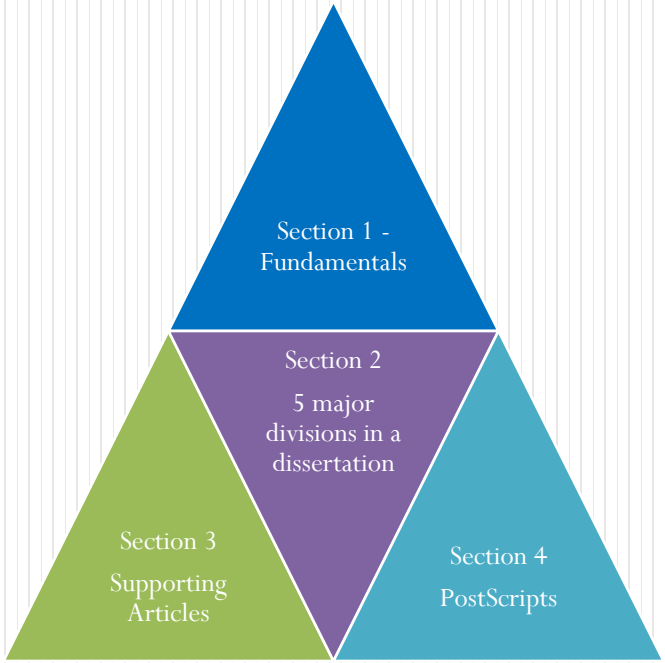
Foundation 5

Dissertation Structures

Session 1.8_1: Structure of Thesis



Writing a mini-dissertation/essay:

Guidelines for MCOM(HRM/IP) Students
SM O'Neil

The structure of your dissertation is the skeleton that supports your work. It may *not* be weak.

Structure of a thesis

Section		Number of chapters
Introduction		Usually one chapter only
Theory		Can be more than one chapter. Structure logical components together.
Research Design		One chapter – although long questionnaire templates may be provided separately in an Appendix.
BODY	Data	What you have found / what you suggest / what you have tested.
	Contribution	What do I contribute from previous section
Conclusion		So – what now?

Structure of thesis

- Title page
- Abstract (with key words)
- Table of content
- List of tables
- List of figures
- Abbreviations
- Declaration of original authorship
- Acknowledgements

Structure of thesis

- Chapter 1: Introductory chapter
- Chapter 2: Overview of literature on central concept(s)
- Chapter 3: A description of the research methods to be used (Methodology)
- Chapter 4: The results of the study
- Chapter 5: The conclusion, limitations and recommendations
- List of references
- Appendices
- The literature chapters are usually not only one chapter – it may be as long as three or four chapters. In other words, Chapters 2, 3 and 4 for instance.

Title Page

.....

(the full title of the dissertation in capital letters)

by

.....

(the full name of the student in capital letters)

Submitted in fulfilment of the requirements for the degree

MCOM HUMAN RESOURCES MANAGEMENT/

MCOM INDUSTRIAL PSYCHOLOGY

(select one)

in the

FACULTY OF ECONOMIC AND MANAGEMENT SCIENCES

at the

UNIVERSITY OF PRETORIA

SUPERVISOR:.....

CO-SUPERVISOR:.....

Abstract

- The abstract is a summary of the study. In short, it tells the reader what the objectives of the study was, the methodology used and the main findings. It should not exceed 350 words.
- The abstract is written after the report has been completed. It will probably be the last thing that you write. Welman and Kruger (2001, p. 223) and Rosnow and Rosenthal (1996, p. 375) propose that the following questions should be answered in a properly compiled abstract:
- *What was the purpose of the study?,What was the research problem?*
- *How was the problem investigated?,What has been found?*
- *What are the implications and the meaning of the findings for the problem posed originally?*

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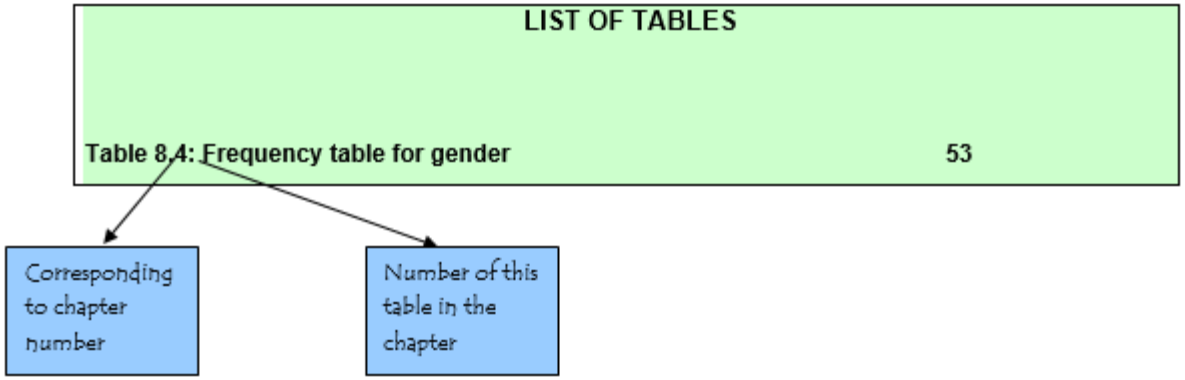
Everything before the first chapter is numbered with small cap roman

List of Tables

- Option 1
- Sequentially numbering Tables / Figures (Table 1, Table 2 … Table n)
- Option 2



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Declaration of original authorship

- It is in this declaration that you declare that:

  - The work presented in the thesis is your own.
  - All the resources used, are cited and credit is given to the various authors.
  - "Generative AI tools were used to improve the clarity of language as I am a second-language writer; however, the ideas, arguments, and content presented remain entirely my own."
  - The work in the thesis was not used to obtain any other qualification at another (or the same) tertiary institute.

I, *Josephine Christa Botes*, declare that "*An analysis of learning in the workplace through narrative discourse analysis*" is my own work. All the resources I used for this study are sited and referred to in the reference list by means of a comprehensive referencing system. I declare that the content of this thesis/article has never before been used for any qualification at any tertiary institute.

Iobsephine Chrita Botes *13 May 2010*

_____

NAME [written out in full] DATE

Signature of student

Exercise: Create thesis structure

- Download the thesis template from the Resources folder
- Include a title page according to FHNW regulations for masters degree

Template is available in the course resources!

The more you can make your work adhere to the standard structure of dissertations, the easier your task will be ..

To session 1.6